

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1979-09-09

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

235.1 PERSECUTION OF THE BAHÁ'ÍS, THE LARGEST RELIGIOUS MINORITY IN IRAN, HAS TAKEN A NEW TURN. EARLY YESTERDAY MORNING A CROWD OF OVER 100 PEOPLE,

INCLUDING THE HEAD OF THE GOVERNMENT DEPARTMENT FOR RELIGIOUS ENDOWMENTS IN SHIRAZ, AND ACCOMPANIED BY 25 REVOLUTIONARY GUARDSMEN

AND 10 OTHER ARMED MEN, ATTACKED THE MOST HOLY HOUSE OF THE BÁB WHICH

WAS ORDAINED BY BAHÁ'U'LLÁH, THE FOUNDER OF THE BAHÁ'Í FAITH, TO BE A PLACE OF PILGRIMAGE FOR HIS FOLLOWERS THROUGHOUT THE WORLD AND IS REGARDED BY

THEM AS THE MOST HALLOWED SPOT IN IRAN. THIS CROWD, WHICH HAD THE KEY TO

THE HOUSE, SMASHED AND DISMANTLED DOORS AND WINDOWS, DESTROYED ORNAMENTAL PLASTERWORK, BREACHED THE WALLS AND HACKED TO PIECES A TREE

IN THE COURTYARD. THIS MORNING THE WORK OF DEMOLITION IS BEING CONTINUED

BY A GROUP OF WORKMEN AND IT IS CLEAR THAT THE PURPOSE IS TO RAZE TO THE

GROUND THE HOUSE OF THE BÁB AND TWO ADJACENT HOUSES WHICH ALSO BELONG

TO THE BAHÁ'Í COMMUNITY.

235.2 A WAVE OF ANGUISHED INDIGNATION IS SWEEPING THE BAHÁ'Í COMMUNITY

THROUGHOUT THE WORLD. WHEN ALL BAHÁ'Í HOLY PLACES IN IRAN WERE SEIZED BY

THE AUTHORITIES IN RECENT MONTHS, THE PROTESTATIONS OF THE BAHÁ'ÍS WERE

MET WITH BLAND ASSURANCES, CONFIRMED IN WRITING, THAT THE TAKEOVER WAS

FOR THE PROTECTION OF THESE SACRED PROPERTIES.

235.3 BAHÁ'ÍS IN EAST AND WEST ARE REGISTERING VEHEMENT PROTESTS WITH
THE

IRANIAN AUTHORITIES.

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

331236 Results of Significant Meetings Addressed by Member

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]